

Glyphweave

User Manual

June 17, 2026

1 Overview

GlyphWeave is a privacy-focused desktop app for storing and editing documents securely on Windows. The files live inside an encrypted **vault** protected by a password and they are never written to disk in readable form. Documents can be opened and edited directly in their normal applications (Word, Adobe, etc.), searched across their contents, and a vault can be synced between computers through any cloud-storage folder the user already uses. Because everything is encrypted on-device, the cloud only ever sees scrambled data (“zero-knowledge”).

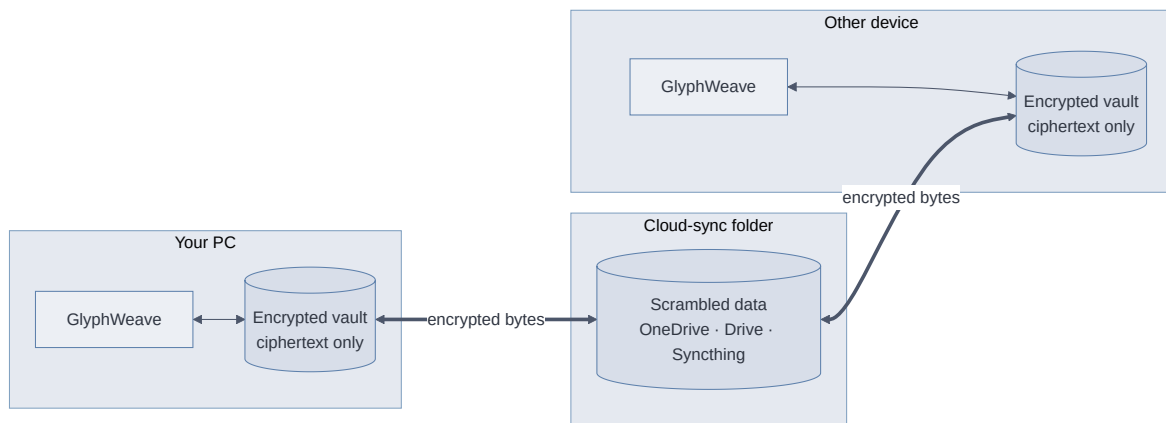


Figure 1: High-level zero-knowledge architecture: each device encrypts and decrypts locally, while the shared cloud-sync folder only ever holds ciphertext.

2 Core Features

- **Encrypted vaults:** Each vault is a password-protected, encrypted store of documents.
- **Transparent editing:** Opening a file launches it in its normal application; edits are re-encrypted automatically on save and close. Plaintext never lands on disk.
- **Import & export:** Files can be brought in from the PC (duplicates are detected and stored only once) or exported as decrypted copies when needed.
- **Folders & organization:** Folders can be created, and entries renamed, moved, copied, or deleted from a familiar tree view.
- **Full-text search:** Search by file name *and* the text inside documents (Thaana/Dhivehi supported). Press **Ctrl+K**.

- **Cross-device sync:** Placing a vault in a cloud-synced folder (OneDrive, Google Drive, Syncthing, etc.) keeps devices in sync automatically.
- **Conflict handling:** If the same item is changed on two devices, both versions are kept. A bell icon notifies the user, and a dialog allows restoring or discarding a version.
- **Recovery phrase:** A 24-word phrase allows access to be regained and a new password set if the vault password is forgotten.

3 System Requirements

- **Operating system:** Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit / x64).
- **Required driver:** WinFsp (file-system driver used to mount files for editing). The installer adds it automatically if it is missing.
- **Hardware:** Runs on any standard Windows 10/11 PC. 100 MiB for application storage. 8 GB ram recommended. More RAM and an SSD help when working with large files or large vaults.
- **Permissions:** Administrator rights are requested *once* during install, only if WinFsp needs to be installed.

4 Installation

1. Download the latest **glyphweave-setup-0.1.x.exe** from the project's **Releases** page.
2. Run the installer.
 - If WinFsp is not already present, the installer requests administrator rights and installs it.
3. Launch **GlyphWeave** from the Start Menu (or the optional desktop shortcut).

5 Setup / First-Time Configuration

On first launch there are no vaults, so the user is guided to create one.

Create your first vault

1. Click **Continue**, then fill in the form:
 - **Vault name:** e.g. **my-documents**.
 - **Storage location:** the folder where the vault is created. *Tip: to sync across devices, pick a folder inside your cloud client* (e.g. ... \OneDrive\Vaults). Defaults to a **Vaults** folder in the home directory.
 - **Password + Confirm password:** This protects the vault. A strong password is required; it cannot be reset without the recovery phrase.
2. Click **Create Vault**.
3. **Record the 24-word recovery phrase.** Write it down and store it somewhere safe. It is the *only* way back in if the password is forgotten.
4. **Confirm the phrase** when prompted to finish setup. The vault opens.

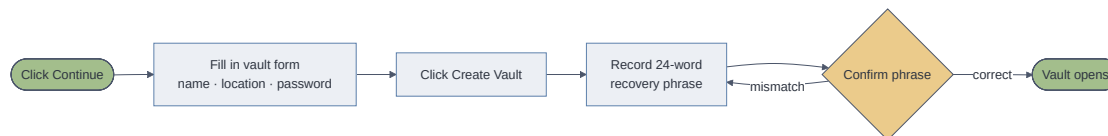


Figure 2: First-time vault creation flow.

Adding an existing vault on another device Once a vault folder has synced to a second PC: open GlyphWeave → **Import an existing vault** (or **File ► Open Vault...**), pick the vault folder, then unlock it with the password.

App settings and the local vault registry are stored automatically under `C:\Users\<you>\.glyphweave`.

6 How to Use

Unlock / lock

- Select a vault, enter the password to unlock.
- Lock it anytime with **Vault ► Lock Vault** (**Ctrl+L**). Locking closes any open files and re-secures everything.

Add files **File ► Import...** (**Ctrl+I**) or drag files in. Choose the destination folder; files are encrypted as they are imported.

Organize Folders can be created, and entries renamed, moved, copied, or deleted from the file view (drag to move; right-click for actions).

Open & edit a document

1. Double-clicking a file opens it in its default Windows application.
2. Edit and **save normally**. Changes are re-encrypted back into the vault.
3. When done, **lock the file** (or lock the vault) to unmount it. Always close/lock before quitting so edits are not lost.

Search Press **Ctrl+K**, type a query, and pick a result to open it. Searches both file names and document contents.

Export (get a plain copy out) Select items → **right-click ► Export...** → choose a destination folder.

Exported copies are decrypted and no longer protected, indexed, or synced. Use with caution.

Sync across devices

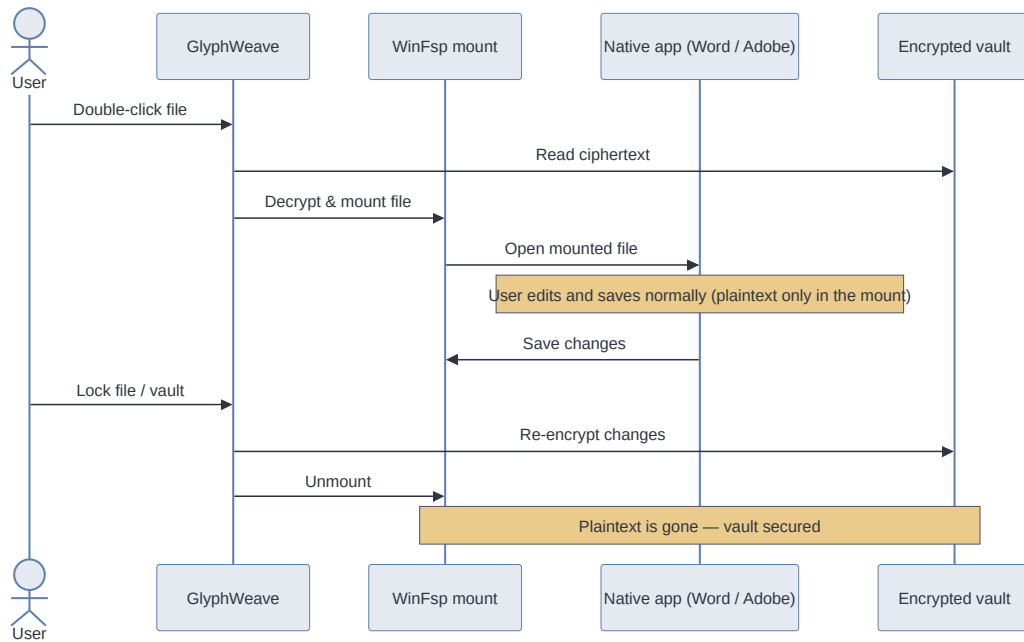


Figure 3: Transparent editing lifecycle: a file is decrypted and mounted via WinFsp, edited in its native application, then re-encrypted and unmounted on lock. Plaintext exists only inside the mount.

- Keep the vault in the cloud-synced folder; sync happens automatically. Force a pass with **Vault ► Sync Now (Ctrl+R)**.
- If two devices edited the same item, click the **bell icon** and use the **Conflict Resolution** dialog to restore or discard the archived version. Both versions are preserved until a decision is made.

Forgot your password? On the unlock screen choose **Forgot password**, enter the 24-word recovery phrase, then set a new password.

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+N	New Vault
Ctrl+O	Open Vault
Ctrl+I	Import
Ctrl+K	Find
Ctrl+R	Sync Now
Ctrl+L	Lock
F5	Refresh
Ctrl+Q	Quit

Handy shortcuts

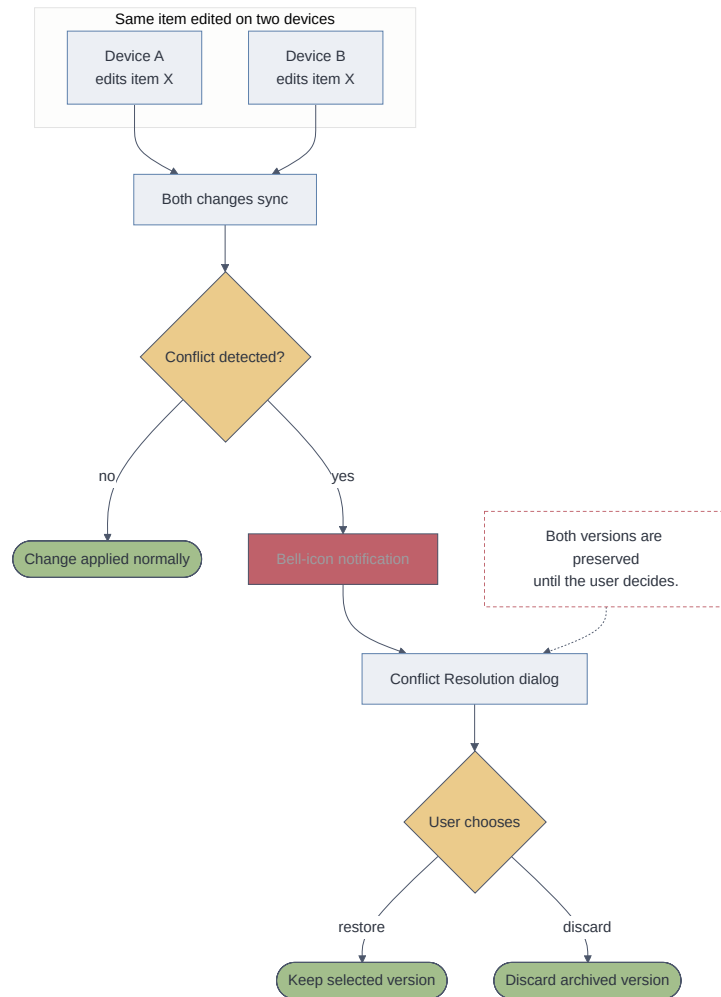


Figure 4: Two-device edit conflict and resolution flow. When the same item is changed on two devices, both versions are retained until the user restores or discards one.

7 Troubleshooting

- **“Incorrect password” when unlocking:** Re-check the password. If it is truly lost, use **Forgot password** with the recovery phrase.
- **A file won’t open / “mount” errors:** WinFsp may be missing or disabled. Reinstall via the Glyphweave installer, then restart Windows.
- **Edits didn’t save:** Make sure the file was saved in the app, then **locked** (file or vault) afterward. Don’t quit Glyphweave while a file is still open/unlocked.
- **Changes aren’t reaching another PC:** Confirm the vault lives inside the cloud-sync folder, that the cloud client is signed in and finished syncing on *both* PCs, then use **Sync Now**. Both devices must have unlocked the vault at least once.
- **A “conflict” appeared:** This is expected when the same item is edited in two places. Open the bell icon → resolve; nothing is lost.
- **Can’t quit / lock the vault:** An import or sync is in progress. Wait for it to finish, then try again.
- **Removing a vault from the list:** **Delete** removes only GlyphWeave’s local record; the actual vault folder stays on disk and can be re-imported. To erase it completely, delete that folder manually afterward.

8 Uninstallation

1. Open **Settings ► Apps ► Installed apps** (or **Add or Remove Programs**).
 2. Find **GlyphWeave** and choose **Uninstall**.
- **WinFsp is left installed**, since other applications may rely on it. Remove it separately if you are sure nothing else needs it.
 - Vault folders are **not** deleted by uninstalling. Delete them manually if no longer wanted (**this is irreversible**).